Editor
Journal of Forecasting

Dear Editor,

Please consider the Research Article "Fixed Heavy-Tailed Probabilistic Forecasting under Missing Historical Observations" for the *Journal of Forecasting*. The manuscript studies probabilistic time-series forecasting when observations are missing from the historical input. It contributes a fixed-mask paired evaluation protocol and a matched-capacity fixed Student-t forecast head, with negative log-likelihood and continuous ranked probability score as the central proper-score evidence.

Across four probability-head seeds on fixed TimePerceiver backbones, the fixed Student-t head improves NLL in 12/12 dataset–seed pairs while satisfying CRPS and point-prediction noninferiority in 12/12. A controlled distribution-family ablation supports fixed heavy tails without learned degrees-of-freedom parameters. A PatchTST assessment preserves NLL and CRPS improvements in 3/3 datasets but transparently reports that Electricity exceeds the prespecified 1% point-error tolerance. This distinction between distributional quality and point accuracy, together with the calibration-and-sharpness analysis, fits the journal's focus on forecasting methodology and evaluation.

[AUTHOR CONFIRMATION REQUIRED: This manuscript is not under consideration elsewhere.]

All authors have approved the manuscript and declarations: **[AUTHOR CONFIRMATION REQUIRED].**

Sincerely,
[CORRESPONDING AUTHOR INPUT REQUIRED]